



Did you know, in the world of tiny, secretive, and fascinating creatures, there's a cool little animal called Bailey's pocket mouse? This tiny creature, usually no larger than your thumb, has a coat that is a blend of gray, brown and cream, helping it blend into its desert home. It also sports big, dark eyes, perfect for seeing in the dark, and an adorable, round body. Their most distinctive feature though, is their 'pocket' - a fur-lined pouch on the outside of their cheeks where they store food for later!



Speaking of food, these little pocket mice sure do love to eat! Their diet mainly consists of seeds, but they also munch on green vegetation, and occasionally, small insects. They have a neat trick to deal with the desert's lack of water - they get most of their hydration from the seeds they eat! When it comes to storing food, their cheek pouches can hold a whole day's worth of food.

Now, you might be wondering where these cute critters live. Bailey's pocket mice are found in the arid desert regions of southwestern USA and northwestern Mexico. They burrow into the sandy soil, creating tunnels and chambers where they sleep during the day and avoid predators. At night, they venture out to forage for food, using their long tail for balance and their sharp claws for digging.



Just like us, these pocket mice have neighbors and friends in their habitat. They share their desert home with other animals like owls, snakes, and coyotes, who might think of them as a tasty snack. But don't worry, they have their own set of defenses, like their excellent hearing and fast running speed to escape! So, even though Bailey's pocket mouse might be tiny, it sure is mighty and full of surprises.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What does a Bailey's pocket mouse's pouch look like?
A. A big mouth filled with food. B. A hidden pocket under their arms.
C. A fur-lined pouch on the outside of their cheeks. D. A small hole on their belly.
- 2) Which country is home to Bailey's pocket mice?
A. India B. Mexico C. Spain D. Japan
- 3) How much food can a Bailey's pocket mouse's cheek pouches hold?
A. A week's worth of food. B. A whole day's worth of food.
C. Three days worth of food. D. A small amount of food.
- 4) When does a Bailey's pocket mouse usually forage for food?
A. In the afternoon. B. During the day.
C. In the morning. D. At night.
- 5) What color is a Bailey's pocket mouse's coat?
A. Yellow, green, and red. B. Gray, brown and cream.
C. Purple, orange, and blue. D. Black and white stripes.
- 6) How do Bailey's pocket mice hydrate themselves?
A. By drinking water stored in their pouches. B. From green vegetation.
C. From the desert rain. D. From the seeds they eat.
- 7) How does a Bailey's pocket mouse avoid predators during the day?
A. They burrow into the sandy soil. B. They hide in tree holes.
C. They run fast to escape predators. D. They blend into the desert with their fur color.
- 8) What do Bailey's pocket mice mainly eat?
A. Seeds. B. Grass. C. Berries. D. Insects.
- 9) From what animal might a Bailey's pocket mouse need to defend itself?
A. Deer. B. Coyotes. C. Squirrels. D. Rabbits.
- 10) What do the pocket mice use their sharp claws for?
A. Grooming. B. Digging. C. Climbing. D. Fighting.
- 11) What is the most distinctive feature of Bailey's pocket mouse?
A. Their big, dark eyes. B. A fur-lined pouch on the outside of their cheeks.
C. Their round body. D. Their tiny size.

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 12) "My fur is a mix of colors, gray, brown, and cream, which helps me blend into my desert home!"
- 13) "I prefer to sleep in open spaces, out in the cool desert air."





- 47) Bailey's pocket mice can't swim very well.
A. cannot B. cannot swim
C. can not D. can't swim
- 48) Bailey's pocket mice aren't found everywhere in North America.
A. is not B. does not
C. has not D. are not
- 49) They're nocturnal, which means they're most active at night.
A. They are B. They were
C. They do D. They have
- 50) This tiny mouse doesn't need to drink water every day.
A. will not B. do not
C. does not D. did not

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 51) Bailey's pocket mice are very good at climbing trees.
52) How do Bailey's Pocket Mice protect themselves from predators?
53) Bailey's pocket mice build nests out of leaves and grass.
54) Bailey's pocket mice have soft fur that is brown or gray in color.
55) Where do Bailey's Pocket Mice live?
56) How small are Bailey's Pocket Mice?



Bailey's Pocket Mouse

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Bailey's Pocket Mouse

Name: _____

1.	C	26.	fact	51.	declarative
2.	B	27.	opinion	52.	interrogative
3.	B	28.	fact	53.	declarative
4.	D	29.	opinion	54.	declarative
5.	B	30.	fact	55.	interrogative
6.	D	31.	opinion	56.	interrogative
7.	A	32.	fact		
8.	A	33.	fact		
9.	B	34.	opinion		
10.	B	35.	opinion		
11.	B	36.	true		
12.	Would	37.	false		
13.	Not	38.	true		
14.	Would	39.	false		
15.	Not	40.	true		
16.	Would	41.	false		
17.	Not	42.	false		
18.	Not	43.	false		
19.	Not	44.	true		
20.	Would	45.	true		
21.	Not	46.	B		
22.	Not	47.	A		
23.	Not	48.	D		
24.	Not	49.	A		
25.	Would	50.	C		